

2047 Is Not Just a Destination. It Is a Responsibility

Building the foundations of a Viksit Bharat, one empowered community at a time

By Dr. Payal Bansal Kanodia



When India completes 100 years of Independence in 2047, the world will undoubtedly look at the size of our economy, the strength of our manufacturing, the sophistication of our technology, the scale of our infrastructure and the influence we wield in the global order. But I believe that the more consequential question will be a simpler one: **what kind of India did we build for our people?**

For me, 2047 is not merely a date on the calendar, nor is **Viksit Bharat** simply an economic aspiration. It is a responsibility. A developed India cannot be built exclusively from its metropolitan centres, industrial corridors and technology parks. It must also be built in its villages, in classrooms where a first-generation

learner discovers the confidence to dream, in households where a woman acquires her first independent income, in fields where a farmer learns to transform cultivation into enterprise, and in communities where young people are equipped not merely to seek employment but to create value. The India of 2047 will be built not only by capital and infrastructure, but by **human capability**.

This is where I believe the role of institutions such as the M3M Foundation becomes especially significant.

Over the last six years, our journey has reinforced a conviction that has become central to everything we do: **nation-building begins long before a factory**

is built. It begins by preparing the people who will eventually build, operate, innovate and lead those factories.

If India is to emerge as a global manufacturing powerhouse, we cannot look at manufacturing merely through the lens of machines, investment and production capacity. Manufacturing requires a vast ecosystem of human capability—skilled workers, technicians, entrepreneurs, digitally literate young people, financially empowered women, productive farmers, healthy communities and resilient local economies.

The foundation of India's manufacturing ambition, therefore, is not only industrial. **It is social.**

From beneficiary to participant